

City Air Makes You Free

(Cities and Freedom/Agency)

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East Asia/Pacific stands out with high effect sizes at about .4 or even .5, also controlling for other predictors of freedom. South Asia stands out as having large positive effect .3-.4 in the smallest category ($< 2k$).

City air makes you free (Stadt Luft macht frei) (?, p. 12) originated in the Middle Ages, and it meant freedom from feudalism in cities, non-feudal islands in a sea of feudalism (?).

1 Data

We use World Bank regions classification.

2 Results

First for all regions in general there is more freedom in smaller areas v top bin, the base case ($> 500k$) in table 1 but controlling for other predictors in table 2 it is just the 2nd (100-500k) and 3rd (50-100k) largest categories, and smaller values in the middle or insignificant; and indeed negative -.07 for the smallest areas ($< 2k$). Next we separate by region.

East Asia/Pacific stands out with high effect sizes at about .4 or even .5, also controlling for other predictors of freedom. Europe flips from some positive effects without controls to negative with controls. Latin America/Caribbean stands out with negative effect in the very smallest areas. Middle East/North Africa has mostly negative effects. North America is positive in 2nd largest category (100-500k). South Asia stands out as having large positive effect .3-.4 in the smallest category ($< 2k$). Sub-Saharan Africa doesn't show a significant differences.

	All	East Asia/Pacific	Europe/Central Asia	Latin America/Caribbean	America	Middle East/North Africa	North America	South Asia	Sub-Saharan Africa
town==2k	-0.03	0.05	-0.05	-0.28***	0.22	-0.07	-0.07	0.39**	-0.29
town==2-5k	0.10***	0.36***	0.17**	-0.13	-0.09	-0.07	-0.07	0.31*	0.06
town==5-10k	0.18***	0.51***	0.11+	-0.01	-0.12	0.13	0.26+	0.35	0.35
town==10-20k	0.04	0.52***	-0.07	0.07	-0.34***	-0.03	0.06	0.19	0.19
town==20-50k	0.15***	0.28***	0.16**	0.08	-0.17*	0.09	0.13	-0.22	-0.22
town==50-100k	0.14***	0.41***	-0.02	0.04	-0.02	0.12	-0.18	-0.06	-0.06
town==100-500k	0.15***	0.55***	-0.05	-0.08+	-0.27***	0.18**	0.36*	-0.45+	-0.45+
constant	7.12***	6.76***	6.98***	7.85***	6.88***	7.44***	7.41***	7.14***	7.14***
N	92216	24560	24103	17285	9846	5833	4226	4694	4694

+ 0.10 * 0.05 **
0.01 *** 0.001; robust std err

Table 1: OLS regressions of freedom/agency

	All	East Asia/Pacific	Europe/Central Asia	Latin America/Caribbean	America	Middle East/North Africa	North America	South Asia	Sub-Saharan Africa
town==2k	-0.07*	0.01	-0.02	-0.16*		-0.00	-0.06	0.30*	-0.02
town==2-5k	0.02	0.30***	0.00	-0.13		-0.13	-0.10	0.25+	0.25
town==5-10k	0.08*	0.37***	0.04	-0.03		-0.17*	-0.03	0.18	0.44+
town==10-20k	-0.00	0.42***	-0.19**	-0.00		-0.33***	-0.02	0.17	0.24
town==20-50k	0.06*	0.24***	-0.02	-0.01		-0.22**	0.05	-0.12	-0.08
town==50-100k	0.13***	0.35***	-0.21***	0.00		-0.02	0.13+	-0.42	0.11
town==100-500k	0.13***	0.51***	-0.19***	-0.03		-0.28***	0.13*	0.27	-0.37
trust	-0.06***	0.06*	0.04	-0.12*		-0.07	0.15***	-0.06	-0.80***
age	0.01*	0.01*	0.00	0.02**		-0.00	0.03**	0.05**	0.02
age2	-0.00**	-0.00*	-0.00	-0.00*		0.00	-0.00**	-0.00*	-0.00
male	0.02	-0.08**	0.04	-0.08*		0.23***	-0.13**	0.05	0.15+
married or living together as married	-0.09***	-0.01	-0.08*	-0.06		0.01	-0.03	0.09	0.23*
Full time	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00		0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Part time	-0.07**	-0.03	-0.05	-0.24***		-0.06	0.10	-0.17	-0.01
Self employed	0.01	-0.12**	0.04	-0.06		-0.05	0.33***	-0.38***	0.20
Retired	0.04	0.15**	-0.09	0.07		0.34**	-0.04	-0.10	-0.17
Housewife	-0.12***	-0.16**	-0.18**	-0.07		-0.11	-0.03	-0.44***	0.02
Students	-0.19***	-0.21**	-0.02	-0.29***		-0.20+	0.08	-0.18	-0.07
Unemployed	0.01	-0.09	-0.13+	-0.04		-0.11	-0.07	-0.02	0.22
Other	0.06	-0.29+	-0.20	0.06		-0.11	0.00	-2.05*	1.40**
class	-0.01	-0.05**	0.10***	-0.00		-0.09**	-0.04	-0.04	0.09*
income	0.03***	0.04***	0.01	0.01		0.06***	0.05*	0.01	0.03
financial satisfaction	0.26***	0.30***	0.29***	0.19***		0.29***	0.25***	0.30***	0.09***
health	0.35***	0.31***	0.25***	0.37***		0.46***	0.50***	0.20***	0.24***
How many children do you have	0.07***	-0.01	0.05***	0.02		0.10***	0.06**	-0.02	-0.08*
religion important	0.05***	0.08***	0.02	0.03+		0.35***	0.10***	0.14	0.21+
Member: Belong to education, arts, music or cultural activities	0.01	-0.03	-0.08	-0.02		0.11	-0.03	-0.00	0.14
Member: Belong to sports or recreation	-0.06**	0.00	-0.02	-0.15**		0.04	-0.06	-0.36**	-0.13
Active/Inactive membership of church or religious organization	0.11***	0.06**	-0.07*	-0.03		0.13**	-0.02	-0.14*	0.10
constant	3.83***	3.25***	4.07***	4.82***		1.91***	2.94***	3.24***	3.82***
N	81093	22574	18548	15903		9037	5728	3654	4442

+ 0.10 * 0.05 **
0.01 *** 0.001; robust std err

Table 2: OLS regressions of freedom/agency

ONLINE APPENDIX

[note: this section will NOT be a part of the final version of the manuscript, but will be available online instead]

fig 1 and 2

weird to think that more ineq and pov would produce more freedom/autonomy; rather i guess lax capitalist friendly regulation would produce more ineq and pov, but should also produce less autonomy/freedom on avg, but it doesn't, there is positive relationship

or maybe the other way round: more freedom/autonomy more ineq and pov

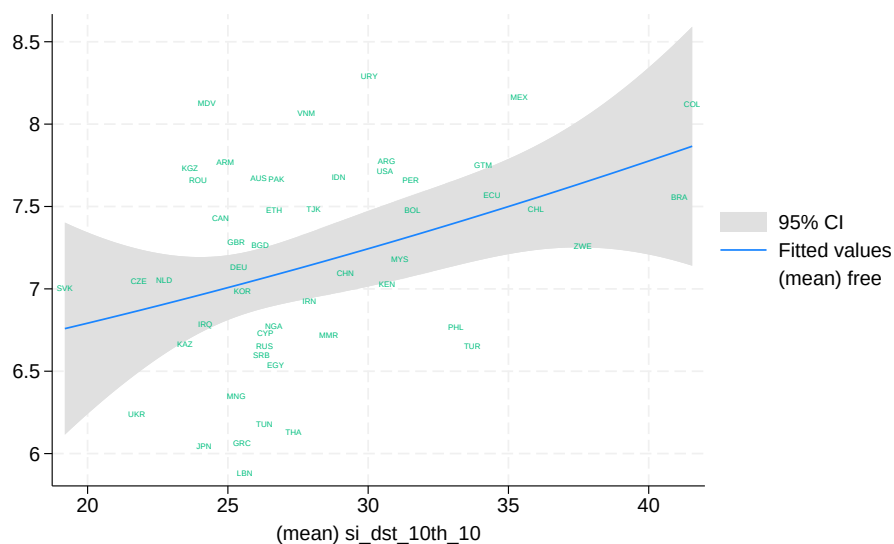


Figure 1: more ineq (inc share held by top 10perc, more autonomy-conservatives would like it!! and pretty strong corr .4

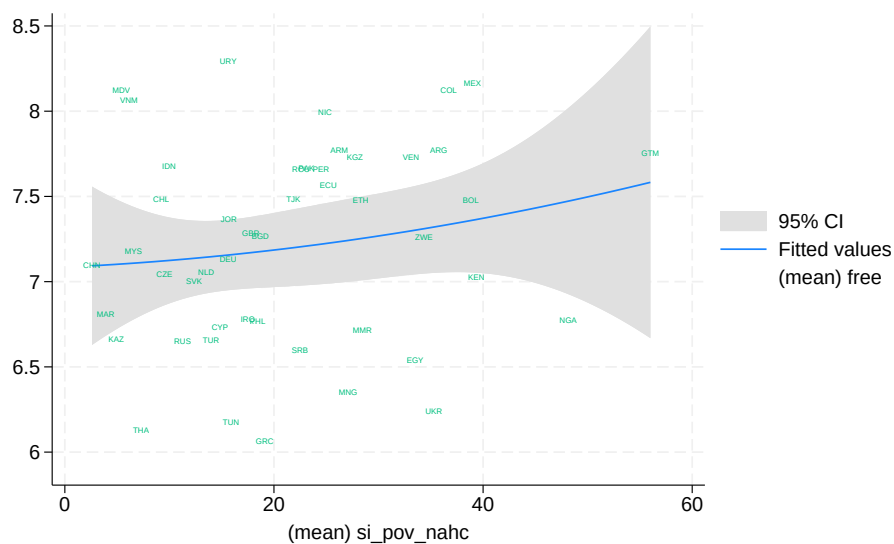


Figure 2: likewise with poverty, but here corr just .2

```
. tabstat ls, by(lwd7) stat(mean sd) format(%9.1f)
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Summary for variables: ls
Group variable: lwd7 (RECODE of lwd (do what you like))

lwd7	Mean	SD
0-4	5.6	2.7
2	7.6	2.3
3	7.6	1.8
4	8.0	1.5
5	7.8	1.9
6	8.2	1.5
7	8.9	1.5
Total	8.3	1.9